



As part of our hiring process, we ask candidates to complete a short take-home assignment. This helps us understand how you approach quality, investigate unfamiliar systems, and communicate findings to an engineering team.

Spare is a security-first, API-first Open Banking platform operating across regulated markets. Our QA engineers take full ownership of quality — from strategy through CI pipelines to production monitoring.

We recommend aiming for around 4–6 hours of focused effort. It doesn't need to be perfect; we're more interested in your approach and thinking.

AI usage: You're welcome to use AI assistants. Just ensure you understand all the code you submit and can explain it in conversation.

Tech Stack & Constraints

- **Runtime/package manager:** Bun
 - **E2E testing:** Playwright
 - **Language:** TypeScript
 - **API testing:** Any TypeScript HTTP library
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The Assignment

You'll be working with [Product Hunt](#) — treat it as a product your team just shipped, and you've been brought in to own quality.

Public API (GraphQL): <https://api.producthunt.com/v2/api/graphql> **API docs:** <https://api.producthunt.com/v2/docs> (Free developer token available at <https://www.producthunt.com/v2/oauth/applications>)

Part 1: Test Strategy

Write a short test strategy document (markdown, max 1 page). If you were the sole QA engineer for this product, what matters and why?

Part 2: Exploratory Testing & Security Assessment

Explore the product and its API. Document what you find — bugs, inconsistencies, security observations — as you would for a real engineering team. Stay within ethical bounds.

Part 3: Automated Tests

Build a test suite covering what you identified as the highest priority:

- **E2E (Playwright):** 5–8 scenarios against the web app. CI-ready, headless, no flaky waits.
 - **API (TypeScript + Bun):** 5–8 tests against the GraphQL API. Typed, isolated, structured.
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What to Submit

A public GitHub repository with a clear structure and a README covering: setup instructions, how to run each suite, summary of findings, architecture decisions, and what you'd do with more time.

After You Submit

In the follow-up interview, we'll ask you to walk through your strategy, demo your tests live, and **write a new test on the spot** for a section of the product we pick. We'll also discuss your findings, trade-offs, and how you'd operationalise this at scale.